
SORA · LA COMPAÑÍA

BUSINESS PROSPECTUS

Sora Casas

Building the home-ownership category for the people moving to Latin America.

June 2026

A vertically-integrated, tourism-fed custom home builder for foreign buyers.

Panama · Mexico · Costa Rica · *Argentina (watch)*

Shareable Edition

For partners & collaborators

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What's inside

A complete breakdown of Sora Casas — the platform thesis, the buyer, the proven Panama core, the competitive field, the engine, the expansion markets, and the economics — grounded in current, sourced data (June 2026).

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HOW TO READ THE DATA

Figures are tagged **official** (government, IMF/World Bank, NAR, large-platform) or **estimate** (broker, agency, modeled). No country here has a U.S.-style MLS, so micro-market prices are indicative asking values, not closed comps. Three dates are load-bearing and decree/legislation-based — the Panama QIV change (Oct 15 2026), the Costa Rica investor-residency sunset (Jul 14 2026), and Argentina's pending golden visa — and must be confirmed with local counsel before external use. Full attributions in the Appendix.

I Executive Summary

A generation of North Americans is relocating to Latin America — and there is no branded, transparent, tourism-fed builder serving them in any of the markets they choose. Sora Casas is built to become that category, country by country, starting where it already has traction.

The opportunity. The U.S. is in the early years of a structural outflow of retirees, financially-independent early-retirees, remote workers, and tax-motivated wealth. An estimated 180,000+ Americans relocated abroad in 2025, 42% of U.S. adults say they have considered it (Harris Poll, 2025), and 703,865 Social Security recipients already collect their checks abroad (SSA). For the retiree and cost-of-living segment, Latin America is the destination: Panama, Costa Rica, and Mexico hold three of the top five spots on International Living's 2026 retirement index. These buyers don't want a resale condo — they want a home, built to their taste, in a place they fell in love with, with the residency visa handled. Nobody is productizing that.

The gap — confirmed in two countries. Direct research into the build-side competition in both Panama and Mexico found the same thing: developers and expat builders hide prices behind "contact us," quote the lot separately from the home, lock buyers into in-house crews, and run multi-year off-plan timelines. **A branded, multi-market builder that publishes a fixed price, a priced spec list, and a committed timeline essentially does not exist.** The one documented transparent build in Panama (Caldera's Boquete project) came in ~\$500 under its quoted budget — proof the model wins. It is a behavior to productize, not a competitor at scale.

The model & the moat. Vertically integrated land → build → sell, financed by buyer deposits more than by banks; five transparently-priced "Casa Modelo" homes, each 3D-customizable, each delivered in nine months, each structured to qualify for residency. The moat is structural: Sora already runs a curated travel brand in its Panama markets, so its guests arrive pre-qualified and on the ground — dissolving the single most expensive step in international real estate.

4

COUNTRY MARKETS —
PANAMA FIRST,
MEXICO LARGEST

~1.6M

AMERICANS IN
MEXICO ALONE — THE
#1 EXPAT
DESTINATION

703,865

U.S. SOCIAL
SECURITY RECIPIENTS
LIVING ABROAD

\$0

CAC ON BUYERS WHO
ARRIVE VIA THE
TOURISM FLYWHEEL

THE THESIS IN ONE LINE

Build the proof in Panama — where Sora has a brand, a travel funnel, and the most traction — then carry the same transparent, tourism-fed, visa-bundled playbook into Mexico (the largest market), then Costa Rica, with Argentina on watch. One operating system, repeated across the markets a relocating American actually chooses.

The sequence

Priority	Market	Why here, why this order
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1 • Beachhead	Panama	Existing Sora brand + travel funnel; #2 world retirement rank; freehold title + a \$300K residency visa on a deadline. Prove the model here.
2 • Scale	Mexico	Largest pool by far (~1.6M Americans; NAR's #1 destination a decade running). Same white space. Higher legal complexity (fideicomiso) = stronger turnkey value-prop.
3 • Extend	Costa Rica	Mature retiree brand; freehold title; a \$150K investor-residency. Adjacent playbook, smaller pool.
4 • Watch	Argentina	Large, undervalued, USD-cash market post-reform — but young macro stability and a pending golden visa. Opportunistic only.

Sources: SSA Annual Statistical Supplement 2024; Harris Poll 2025; WSJ (2026); International Living Global Retirement Index 2026; NAR 2025 International Transactions; build-side competitor research (see §6, §12). Full citations in Appendix.

2 The Platform Thesis

The product is a home; the business is a repeatable operating system. What makes Sora a platform — not a local builder — is that the same machine works in every market a relocating North American chooses.

2.1 • Why a platform, not a builder

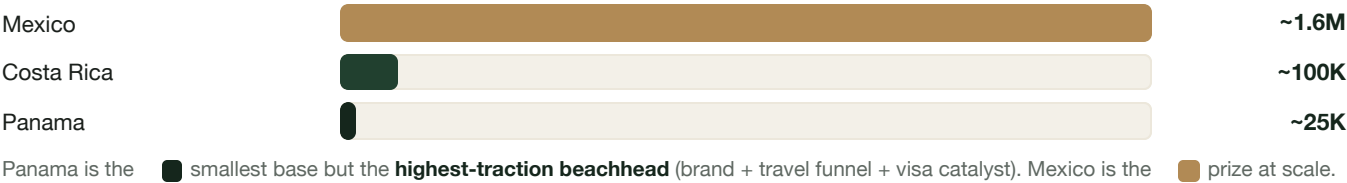
A single-market builder is capped by one geography's demand and one set of incumbents. But the buyer is not loyal to a country — they are loyal to a *life*: warm climate, lower cost, a community, a visa, the dollar going further. That buyer shops Panama against Costa Rica against Mexico. A brand that meets them in all three — with the same transparent pricing, the same 3D configurator, the same visa-bundled, titled-only promise — compounds trust and marketing across borders. The research is unambiguous: **the same structural white space (no branded transparent turnkey-for-foreigners builder) exists in every target market.** The playbook is portable; the brand is the asset.

2.2 • The four markets, compared

Dimension	Panama 🇵🇦	Mexico 🇲🇽	Costa Rica 🇨🇷	Argentina 🇦🇷
2026 retirement rank	#2	#5	#3	—
Americans in-country	~20–30K	~1.6M	~70–120K	small
Foreign freehold title?	Yes (Art. 17)	Coastal: via <i>fideicomiso</i> trust	Yes (equal rights)	Urban: yes; rural restricted
Residency-by-RE visa	QIV \$300K → \$500K Oct 15 '26	None (no golden visa)	Investor \$150K (sunset risk Jul '26)	Golden visa ~\$500K (pending)
Currency risk	None (USD)	Peso (moderate)	Colón (moderate)	High (peso, recovering)
Sora status	Beachhead	Scale (#2)	Extend (#3)	Watch

Sources: International Living 2026; State Dept / INEGI / ARCR (expat counts); Kraemer Law, MexLaw, Ley 9996, Decree 524/2025; PwC. Expat counts are estimates; see §5 & §12.

The addressable expat base — Americans living in each market (log-scale gap is the point: Mexico dwarfs the rest)



WHY PANAMA GOES FIRST DESPITE THE SMALLEST BASE

Beachheads are chosen for *winnability*, not size. Panama gives Sora an existing brand, an operating travel funnel that feeds buyers at near-zero cost, the cleanest legal setup (freehold title + a residency visa on a hard deadline), and zero currency risk. We prove unit economics and produce a portfolio of delivered, photographed, testimonial homes here — then walk into Mexico's far larger market with proof in hand instead of a pitch.

2.3 · What carries across borders (and what doesn't)

Portable (the platform)	Localized per market
The transparent fixed-price + 3D-configurator product	Land partners, build crews, subcontractor pricing
The brand, website, content engine & demand machine	Ownership mechanics (freehold vs fideicomiso vs concession)
The five promises & the titled-only / clean-title standard	The residency-visa bundle (different program each country)
The tourism flywheel & community model	Local broker/ACOBIR-equivalent membership & co-broke
The CRM, lead spine, pipeline & unit-economic model	Conference/channel partners & the local incumbent set

3 Why Latin America, Why Now

A structural wave of Americans is leaving — and for the retiree, cost-of-living, and financial-independence segments, Latin America is where they land.

3.1 • The wave is real, and it is measurable

- **42%** of U.S. adults have considered or plan to relocate abroad (Harris Poll, Mar 2025) — Gen X 35%, Boomers 26%. Gallup puts ~20% wanting to leave *permanently*, near a record.
- **~180,000+** Americans relocated abroad in 2025 (WSJ analysis across 15 destination countries — "almost surely higher").
- **703,865** Social Security beneficiaries already live abroad (SSA, Dec 2023), 454,002 of them retired workers — the verified core of the retiree pool.
- Drivers, quantified (Harris 2025): cost of living **49%**, dissatisfaction with political leadership **48%**, quality of life **43%**.

HONEST FRAMING

"180,000 left" is a directional departure signal, not proof of net-negative migration (the U.S. doesn't count citizen emigration, and arrival data muddies the net figure). And broad "leave America" sentiment skews toward Europe/Canada. **Latin America wins specifically in the retiree + cost-of-living + financial-independence + HNW-tax segments** — which is exactly Sora's buyer. We target that segment, not the generic young political-exit crowd.

3.2 • Latin America is where the retiree segment goes

Three of Sora's four markets sit in the global top five for retirement (International Living 2026: Panama #2, Costa Rica #3, Mexico #5). The hard government data confirms the flow: Panama's Friendly Nations Visa approvals rose **+52% YoY (3,228 in 2024)** with record Pensionado approvals, and Mexico granted Americans **~85% more temporary-resident visas** in 2022 than in 2019. The dollar going further, no tax on foreign income across most of the region, and a 3-hour flight from the U.S. do the rest.

42%

U.S. ADULTS HAVE CONSIDERED
RELOCATING ABROAD (HARRIS
2025)

3 of 5

TOP GLOBAL RETIREMENT
SPOTS ARE SORA MARKETS (IL
2026)

18.5M

U.S. DIGITAL NOMADS IN 2025,
+153% VS 2019 (MBO)

Sources: Harris Poll (Mar 2025); Gallup (2025); WSJ via Daily Beast (2026); SSA Annual Statistical Supplement 2024 (Table 5.J); International Living Global Retirement Index 2026; IMI Daily (Panama immigration, Feb 2025); MBO Partners 2025.

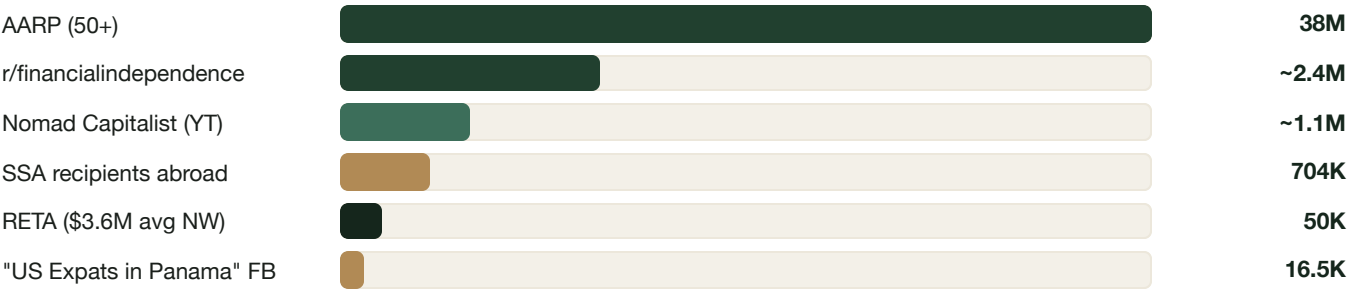
4 The U.S. Buyer — Who, Where, How

Specific, named, high-intent audiences — not "retirees." This is who to target, where they cluster geographically, what signals their intent, and where to meet them at each stage of awareness.

4.1 • The high-intent segments (named, sized)

Segment	Where they gather (size)	Intent & fit
HNW overseas-RE buyers	RETA — 50,000 members, avg net worth \$3.6M ; Nomad Capitalist ~1.1M YouTube	Closest fit of all — they buy real estate abroad <i>now</i> . The single best audience.
Near/early retirees	703,865 SSA-recipients-abroad pool; AARP 38M members 50+	The core buyer (Persona A). Reached via House Hunters International + International Living.
FIRE / geo-arbitrage	r/financialindependence ~2.4M; r/Expatriate ~137K; ChooseFI; MMM forum 45K	Geo-arbitrage retire-abroad is the premise. Cost-comparison content converts them.
Plan-B / political exit	r/AmerExit ~204K; r/IWantOut (large); "US Expats in Panama" FB 16,500+	Highest explicit intent. The visa-bundle + Oct-2026 deadline message.
Remote workers / nomads	18.5M U.S. nomads; r/digitalnomad ~2.4M; Nomad List	Persona B (surfer family). Skews "live abroad" over "buy" — nurture to buy.

Relative reach of the targetable communities (members / audience, log-ish scale)



Lookalike audiences off the small, high-intent lists (■ RETA, the Panama FB group) outperform broad targeting — see §8.

4.2 • Where they are — geographic concentration

Relocation-abroad intent over-indexes where four signals stack: high tax/cost, retiree out-migration, passport density, and political-exit search spikes.

Targeting motive	Geographies	Signal
Cost / tax exit	California, New York, New Jersey, Illinois	Net domestic out-migration FY24: CA –239,575, NY –120,917, IL –56,235 (Census). NJ #1 outbound 7 yrs (United Van Lines). Passport density highest in NJ/MA/NY.
Warm-climate retiree	FL, AZ corridors + CA/NY/NJ/IL retiree out-flow	Retiree out-migration CA –56,858, NY –39,123 → already willing to move.
Political exit	VT, ME, OR, WA + swing WI, PA	Post-2024 "move out of the country" search +800%.

4.3 • The affinity signals (for ad targeting)

House Hunters International (HGTV) is the most on-the-nose signal — ~863K viewers/airing, franchise 13M+/month, and its Latin America episodes (Mexico, Costa Rica, Panama, Belize) are prominent. Stack it with **AARP / 50+**, **International Living** readership, "buying property abroad" / FIRE interests, Duolingo-Spanish behavior, and lookalikes off the "US Expats in Panama / Mexico" Facebook members. (Coldwell Banker's 2023 luxury survey found 92% of affluent U.S. households were looking to buy abroad, with **Central America the #1 targeted region at 23%** — directional but striking.)

The awareness funnel

The buyer's journey runs 6–18 months across four stages. Each stage has its own communities, its own content, and its own right move — the engine in §8 meets them at all four.



THE TWO ANCHOR AUDIENCES

If only two segments get budget: **(1) RETA's 50,000 overseas-real-estate buyers (\$3.6M avg net worth)**, and **(2) the 703,865 SSA-recipients-abroad + AARP 50+ pool**, reached through House Hunters International / International Living affinities and lookalikes off the Panama Facebook group. Everything else is supporting fire.

Sources: GummySearch (subreddit sizes, Jun 2026); SSA 2024; AARP; MBO Partners 2025; Census/IRS migration FY24; United Van Lines 48th study; Parrot Analytics / HGTV (House Hunters); Coldwell Banker Global Luxury 2023; moveBuddha 2025.

5 Panama — The Beachhead

The proving ground: a uniquely stable, dollarized, freehold-title market with a residency visa on a hard deadline — and the one place Sora already has a brand and a travel funnel.

5.1 • The macro foundation

Pillar	The fact	Why it matters to a foreign buyer
Dollarization	Balboa pegged 1:1 to USD since 1904; the U.S. dollar is the paper currency. No central bank, no devaluation history.	Zero FX risk — the cleanest of all four markets.
Territorial tax	Only Panama-sourced income is taxed; foreign pensions, Social Security, offshore gains exempt. No wealth tax.	A retiree's pension is untaxed by Panama.
Growth & credit	GDP +4.4–4.5% (2025), +3.8–3.9% (2026); investment-grade at S&P (BBB-) & Moody's; junk at Fitch since the 2023 mine closure.	Among the region's strongest; deficit cut 7.4%→3.7% of GDP.
Ownership	Foreigners hold freehold title with citizens' rights (Art. 17); our four markets sit outside the 10 km border zone (Art. 291).	Direct, mortgageable, registered ownership — no trust required.

5.2 • The four markets

Indicative residential price per m² (USD) — asking values; build cost is far below all of them

Playa Venao (beachfront condo)		~\$3,700
Boquete (new construction)		~\$1,030
Boquete (median resale)		~\$990
Pedasí oceanfront (lot)		\$200–450
Volcán (lot)		from ~\$60

Build cost for a quality custom home runs ~\$1,200–2,000/m² — far below Venao resale. That gap is the business.

Market	Buyer	Note
Pedasí / Azuero (Venao)	Retirees + surf/rental families	Safest community in Panama; strongest pricing power; oceanfront lots +45% since 2020
Boquete	Established N.-American retirees	Median home ~\$249K; ~20% of residents are expats (~5,000+)
Volcán	Value / second-home buyers	"The next Boquete"; undefended market; lowest entry prices
Bocas del Toro	Caribbean / off-grid	>85% Right-of-Possession, not titled — Sora's titled-only opening

5.3 • The catalyst & the on-ramp

The Qualified Investor Visa grants *immediate permanent residency* for a \$300,000 titled-property investment — and that threshold **rises to \$500,000 on October 15, 2026**. It is the hardest deadline in international real estate. Meanwhile Panama crossed **3.0M tourist arrivals in 2025** (+8.4%), the U.S. its #1 source — the flow Sora's own travel brand taps directly (§10).

RISK FLAG — VERIFY BEFORE EXTERNAL USE

The Oct 15, 2026 QIV date is decree-based (program by Decree 722/2020; the \$300K window reported under Decree 193/2024) and has been postponed before. Build the campaign around it, but have Panamanian counsel confirm the citation and that it hasn't moved before it appears in buyer-facing material.

Sources: PwC; IMF/World Bank; S&P/Moody's/Fitch; Global Property Guide; Casa Solution; AirROI; Newsroom Panama (ATP); Kraemer Law / Global Citizen Solutions (QIV). See §3, Appendix.

6 The Competitive Landscape

The deep version: not just the brokers who resell, but the builders who are Sora's true competition. Across both, the same finding — transparent, integrated building is open ground.

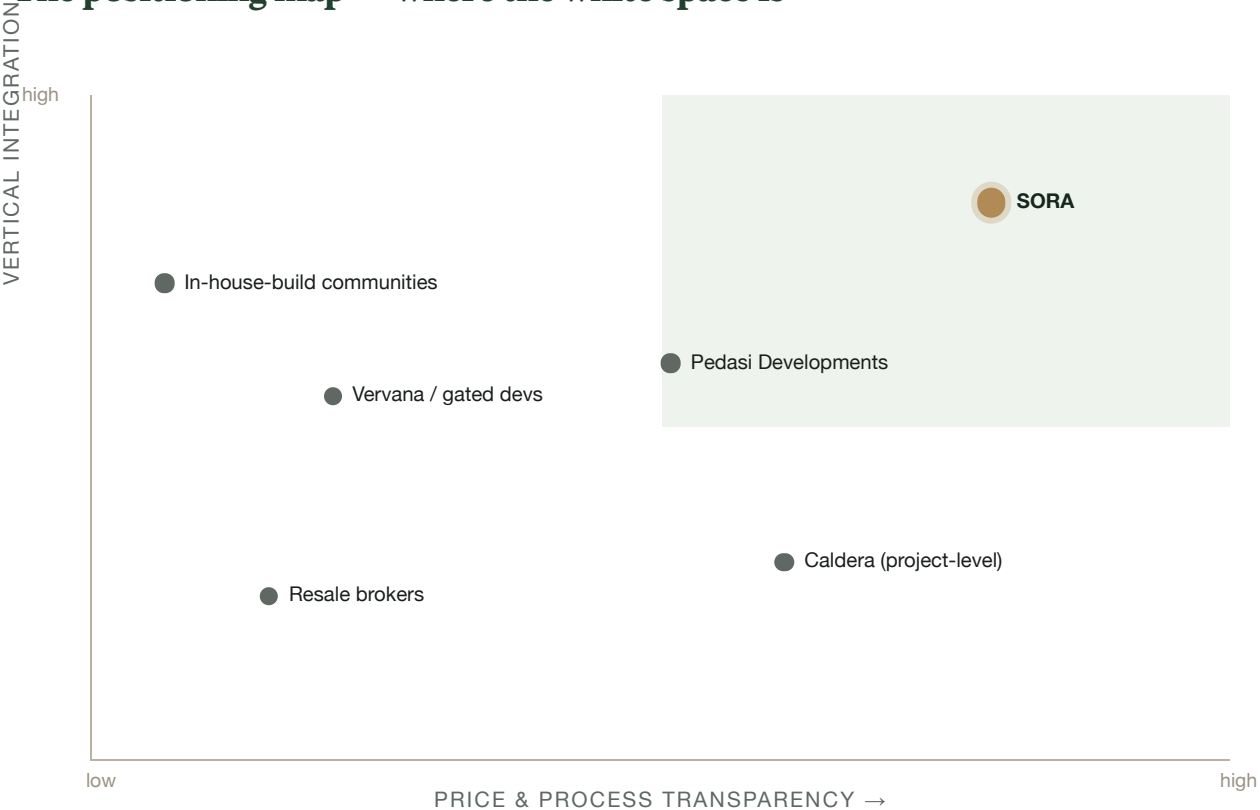
6.1 • The build-side — Sora's real competitors

Brokers sell what others build; the firms Sora actually competes with are developers and design-build shops. Research into them surfaced a consistent pattern of **opaque pricing, the "lot quoted separately" trick, in-house-builder lock-in, and multi-year off-plan timelines.**

Builder / developer	Market	Model	Transparency
Pedasi Developments (closest analog)	Pedasi/Venao	7 pre-designed models; claims 6–10-mo turnkey	Mixed — one published price, rest quote-only
Caldera Construction *	Boquete	Custom design-build; the documented transparent case	Transparent — priced spec list, came in ~\$500 under budget
Vervana (FRAPAN)	Playa Venao	Furnished condos/villas, ~3-yr build	Opaque — "from ~\$535K," no list
The Woods / Lucero / Los Molinos	Boquete	Gated communities; some in-house-builder lock-in; "up to 18-mo" builds	Mixed → opaque; lot-separate pricing
CMRW / Casa de Montaña	Boquete	Design-build, ~\$70–120/sq ft	Opaque on total price

* Caldera's transparent Hartsell project (retireinpanamatours.com, 2022) is the proof case Sora productizes. Builder pricing is the weakest data class — many figures are realtor listings, not developer sheets; material-substitution clauses live in unpublished contracts. Sources: company sites; panama-properties; Casa Solution; Prestige; livinginpanama (2025–2026).

6.2 • The positioning map — where the white space is



THE EMPTY QUADRANT

The top-right — **high transparency × high vertical integration** — is empty. Pedasi Developments approaches integration but stays opaque on price; Caldera is transparent but project-by-project, not a brand or a platform. **No one occupies the transparent + integrated + branded + multi-market position.** That is precisely where Sora sits — and the same map holds in Mexico (§12), where research found "no dominant branded multi-market turnkey-for-foreigners franchise."

6.3 · The brokers — competitors that are also partners

Panama runs on collaborative commission splits, so the incumbents are simultaneously co-broke partners. The brand to beat is **Panama Equity** (800+ listings, ~34K visits/mo, best content cadence); the deepest inventory is **Casa Solution** (2,000–2,500 listings); the strongest U.S./Canada funnel into Pedasí is **Panama Sovereign**. Sora doesn't fight them on listing volume — it owns the build-and-brand quadrant they can't occupy, and co-brokers their inventory (§9).

7 The Sora Model

Vertically integrated land → build → sell, financed by buyers more than by banks, wrapped in a hospitality brand and five promises no competitor makes.

7.1 • The five promises

Promise	What it means
1 • 30-day visit	First inquiry to standing on your lot in 30 days; \$1,500 flight credit at closing.
2 • Transparent price	Every model published with full turnkey price by tier and region; a live cost calculator. No competitor publishes prices.
3 • Nine-month delivery	Fixed-price USD contract, milestone payments, penalty clauses both ways.
4 • Title + attorney	Titled-only land; bilingual attorney before money moves; clean-title guarantee package.
5 • Visa built in	Each home structured to qualify for the relevant residency program (FNV/QIV in Panama; the local equivalent in each market).

PROMISE #4 IS A PRODUCT, BECAUSE PANAMA HAS NO TITLE INSURANCE

No major U.S. title underwriter (Stewart, First American) writes policies in Panama. Rather than a weakness, Sora makes the **clean-title guarantee** its own trust product — independent attorney search + Registro Público *finca* verification + Right-of-Possession screening — addressing the #1 deal-killer head-on (the analog is the *fideicomiso* in Mexico, the maritime-zone concession check in Costa Rica).

7.2 • The product & the capital model

Five "Casa Modelo" homes, each 3D-customizable, each in three finish tiers (*Esencial* / *Sora* / *Firma*), each delivered in nine months. The model is engineered so the customer finances the build:

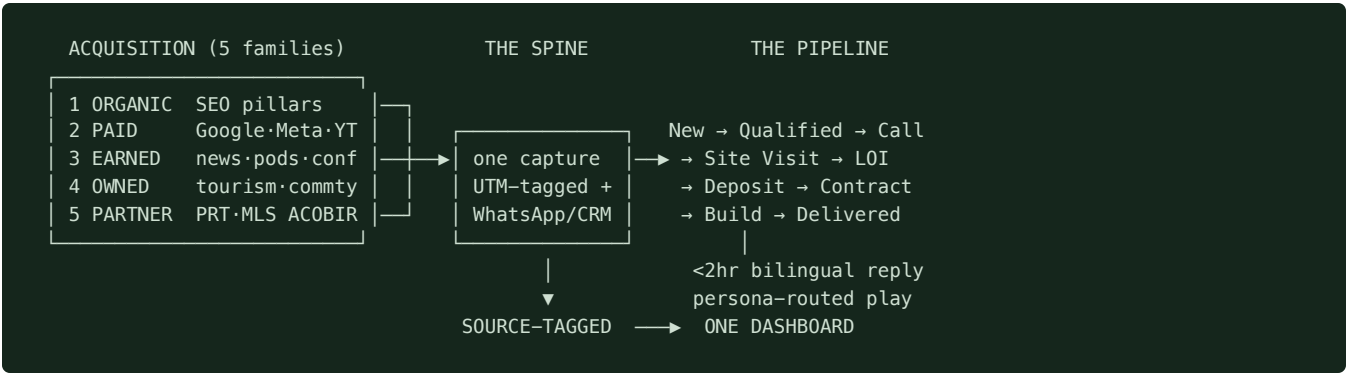
Instrument	Share of build cost	Cost of capital
Buyer capital (deposits + milestones)	60–80%	Interest-free
Land-partner equity (land at cost, profit share)	5–10% of project	No cash outflow until sale
Working-capital line / bridge	10–25%	Self-funded from committed founder capital for the first 3–5 builds; LOC at ~9–12% thereafter

WHY THIS IS THE ADVANTAGE

Per-build gross profit is \$80K–\$150K on a \$350K–\$500K sale price (22–28% margin). The first two to three builds are self-funded from founder capital to prove unit economics and produce closed-buyer testimonials — which then unlock construction debt on real terms and de-risk the move into Mexico. Capital recycles per build with positive carry.

8 The Demand-Generation Engine

Five channel families feed one lead spine, routed by persona into one pipeline, worked at a two-hour SLA, measured on one number: cost per discovery call by source.



8.1 • The funnel math, on real 2025–2026 benchmarks

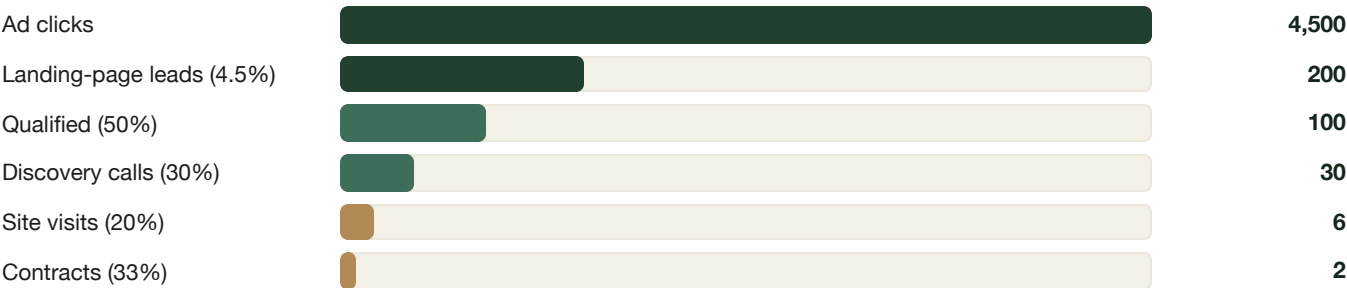
Lever	Benchmark	Source
Google real-estate CPC / CPL	\$3.22 / ~\$102	WordStream 2026
Meta real-estate CPL (lead forms) / CVR	\$16.61 / 10.68%	WordStream FB 2025
Real-estate landing page CR (median / top)	2.6% / 10–15%+	First Page Sage; Unbounce 2026
3-field vs 9-field form	10.1% vs 3.6%	Landingi 2026
International buyers close vs domestic	~50% vs ~33%	NAR 2025

THE SPEED-TO-LEAD EDGE, QUANTIFIED

Responding in **5 vs 30 minutes** makes contact ~100× more likely and qualification ~21× more likely (MIT). Within the first hour vs 60 minutes later: ~7× more likely to qualify (HBR, 2.24M leads). **78% buy from the first company that responds.** The field responds in 24–48 hours; Sora promises a bilingual WhatsApp video tour in under two hours — a structural advantage worth more than any creative.

8.2 • The working funnel (\$15K/mo paid, \$400K avg sale)

Monthly volume by stage — the leak is the site-visit step (engineer against it with the flight credit)



2 × \$400K = **\$800K revenue** at \$15K spend → CPL \$75, cost/discovery-call \$500, cost/buyer \$7,500, CAC/revenue ~0.9%.

The highest-ROI tactic is **subsidizing the discovery-trip flight** (\$1,500 credit at closing): site-visit→contract runs 25–40%, so every extra visit is worth ~\$80K. One lead spine writes every channel's leads into one source-tagged record, routed to the

right rep within the SLA and tracked through eight stages (*New → Qualified → Call → Site Visit → LOI → Contract → Build → Delivered*).

9 Key Contacts & Businesses to Engage

The named engagement list — who to partner with, and the move. Public business entities only; every referral split goes in writing (Panama has no enforceable co-broke law).

9.1 • Distribution & media partners

Partner	Reach	The move
Panama Relocation Tours (Jackie Lange)	7,000+ clients / 64 countries; 300th tour Aug 2025; 4.9★/789 TripAdvisor; 6,900+ FB community	#1 target — preferred custom-home referral partner; sponsor a build-site stop on the Chiriquí leg
Live and Invest Overseas	500,000+ readers; Panama City HQ; conferences + podcast	Co-publish a "build in Pedasí/Boquete" lead magnet; sponsor the May summit
International Living	185K+ daily e-letter; ~1M visits/mo; Retirement Index publisher	Pitch a "build vs buy" data story; first paid placement (hard sellable numbers)
RETA (Ronan McMahon)	50K members, \$3.6M avg net worth	Featured-deal placement — the closest-fit audience
Nomad Capitalist	~1.1M YouTube; HNW	"Build your home + Panama residency" integration
FB: US Expats in Panama / American Society of Panama	16,500+ / 20,000+	Value presence + admin AMAs — never link-drop

9.2 • Co-broke brokerages • Listing platforms • Institutions

Co-broke / referral: Casa Solution (clearest co-broke terms, Boquete/Volcán) · Panama Equity (Pedasí office — refer, don't compete) · Inside Panama (Bocas, multilingual) · Panama Sovereign · Open Doors · RE/MAX Highlands (Chiriquí).

Listing / MLS: MLS ACOBIR (400+ agents; partner one member per market, pursue developer membership) · Encuentra24 (~2M visits/mo, US 14%) · Properstar (intl shop window for Bocas/Chiriquí) · Compreoalquile.

Institutional / events 2026: ACOBIR (join as promoter/developer member) · Invest Panama Summit (May 28–30) · LIO International Property Summit (May 20–22) · CAPAC Expo Hábitat (Sep 24–27, B2B sourcing).

Tooling / legal: Configurator — Cedreo / Dwellito / Renoworks (white-label, deposit capture) · Title — build the clean-title guarantee (no U.S. underwriter operates in Panama) · Law — Kraemer & Kraemer (Boquete + Bocas), Quijano (~30-day relocation), Anaya (Bocas ROP).

FIRST FIVE MOVES

- 1 · File ACOBIR (Corredor + Promotora) — 60-day lead time.
- 2 · Sign Panama Relocation Tours as referral partner.
- 3 · Request the International Living media kit.
- 4 · Co-broke MOU with Casa Solution + one Bocas incumbent.
- 5 · Retain Kraemer & Kraemer for title + immigration.

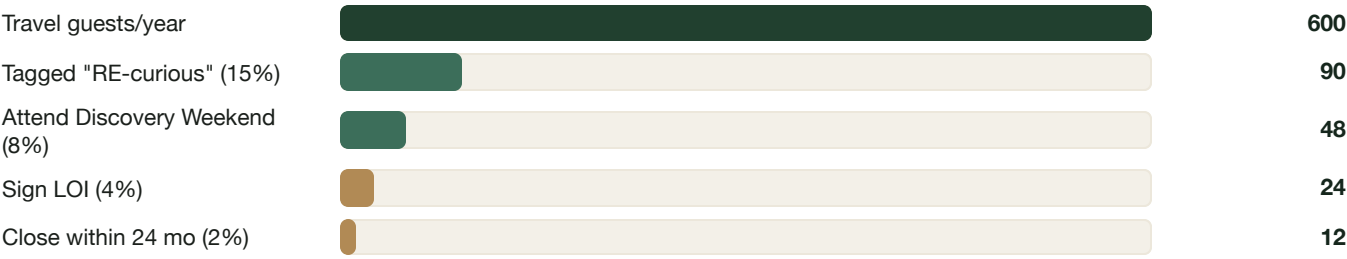
Sources: company PR / sites; TripAdvisor (live Jun 2026); Newsroom Panama (Sep 2025); Similarweb (May 2026); acobir.com; conference sites. Reach figures are largely self-reported — see Appendix.

10 The Tourism Flywheel

The structural advantage no competitor can replicate without first building a multi-market curated travel brand. Sora already has it in Panama — and it becomes the template for every new market.

International real estate's brutal math: cold leads convert to buyers at 0.4–1.5%, and the expensive bottleneck is simply getting the buyer on the ground. Sora's guests have already taken the flight and fallen for the place — a "site visit" is a 90-minute Sunday stroll. We never sell during the weekend; the geography sells, and we hold a door open gently five times, ending in the paid **Discovery Weekend**, where 50–70% of attendees sign letters of intent.

Cross-pollination math — ~600 Panama travel guests/year



THE ENGINE

~12 closings a year from the tourism funnel alone, at **near-zero CAC** — roughly \$1.2M of gross profit no competitor can touch — plus 24 LOIs compounding forward, plus a Discovery Weekend product that runs at a standalone profit. Travel and real estate stay related-but-separate brands (Aman Resorts / Aman Residences); the moment a guest feels sold to, the brand cracks, so brand-boundary discipline is a hard rule.

II Community as Moat

The buyer doesn't move for the house — they move for the Sunday lunch with people they want to know. The community Sora seeds becomes its most important referral engine.

- **Quarterly "Sora Sundays"** in each market — homeowners, hosts, and a few Discovery-Weekend prospects.
- **A moderated WhatsApp community per market** — everyday utility plus social plans.
- **The Sora Concierge** — bilingual post-delivery service (residency renewals, healthcare, vendors); subscription tier, free for premium buyers.
- **The annual gathering** — all homeowners plus invited prospect couples (often next year's buyers).
- **The referral economy** — a homeowner who introduces a buyer earns \$5,000 in Sora credit. ~\$5K per referral closing vs ~\$7.5K cold CAC, at higher quality and conversion.

WHY IT COMPOUNDS — AND WHY IT TRAVELS

Within 24 months, 30+ homeowners drive an estimated 10–15 referral closings a year, heading toward ~40% of pipeline by year three. The only way into the community is to become a homeowner, so Sora's pricing power *grows* over time. And because the community model is brand-level, not place-level, it becomes the warm-welcome template that de-risks each new-country launch.

I2 Expansion Markets

Where the platform goes after Panama proves it — the largest pool first (Mexico), then an adjacent retiree brand (Costa Rica), with a high-risk/high-reward option on watch (Argentina).

12.1 • Mexico — the prize at scale (target #2)

Mexico is the largest foreign-buyer market in the hemisphere and the #1 destination for U.S. buyers abroad a decade running (NAR). Roughly **1.6M Americans** live there; Lake Chapala/Ajijic alone holds 15–20K retirees. And the build-side research found the same white space as Panama: **no dominant branded multi-market turnkey-for-foreigners franchise exists.**

Market	Price/m² (USD)	Character
Playa del Carmen	~\$3,830	Established Caribbean; coastal → fideicomiso
Tulum	\$3,500–5,000	Boom→correction (–10/–20%); bespoke-build tailwind
Los Cabos	~\$4,000–4,500	Ultra-luxury; 60% U.S. buyers; highest STR revenue
Puerto Vallarta / Nayarit	~\$3,800	Pacific resort; Sayulita STR yields to ~13.8%
San Miguel de Allende	~\$2,400	UNESCO arts/retiree; inland → no fideicomiso
Mérida (Yucatán)	homes ~\$250K	Safe colonial; inland; deepest legal simplicity

THE TWO THINGS THAT MAKE MEXICO DIFFERENT

(1) The fideicomiso. Within 50 km of coast / 100 km of borders, foreigners hold property through a 50-year renewable bank trust (~\$1–3K setup, ~\$500–1K/yr) — added complexity that *increases* a turnkey builder's value. A 2025 proposal to abolish it is pending, not passed. **(2) No golden visa.** Mexico has no residency-by-real-estate program; residency runs on income/savings thresholds (Temporary ~\$4,400/mo; Permanent ~\$7,400/mo). So the "visa built in" promise becomes a residency-and-solvency concierge, not a property-qualifies pitch. Entry strategy: start inland (San Miguel, Mérida — direct deed, deepest relocation-channel infrastructure) before the higher-complexity coast.

12.2 • Costa Rica — the adjacent retiree brand (target #3)

A mature retiree destination (#3 globally, 2026) with **freehold title equal to citizens** and ~70–120K Americans. Foreign buyers are ~40% of the national market and 70–80% in coastal hubs. The build-cost-to-resale spread holds (build ~\$1,270/m² national vs Guanacaste resale \$1,580–2,990/m²), and turnkey-for-foreigners analogs exist but are local and fragmented (KRAIN, Blue Zone Realty; builders like Magnolia, Guanacaste Builders).

TIME-SENSITIVE — VERIFY BEFORE ANY CR CLAIM

The **\$150,000 investor-residency** threshold (Ley 9996, down from \$200K) and its tax breaks are **scheduled to sunset July 14, 2026** unless extended — the minimum could revert to \$200K. Confirm with DGME before using the figure. Note also the maritime zone: the first 200 m inland is concession-only land (first 50 m fully public), and foreigners need 5 years' residency for a majority concession — so Sora builds on *titled* land beyond 200 m.

12.3 • Argentina — watch-list only

Post-reform Argentina is large, undervalued, and a USD-cash market (Mendoza ~\$1,000–1,200/m², roughly half of Buenos Aires). Milei lifted most capital controls in April 2025 (backed by a \$20B IMF deal); the blue-dollar gap collapsed from 50–80% to under 3%, and inflation fell from ~211% to ~31%. A new **golden visa (~\$500K, no residency required)** is framework-approved but **not yet open** (regs pending, launch expected H2 2026).

WHY IT STAYS ON WATCH

The stabilization is young and IMF-dependent; profit repatriation is freer but untested across a full cycle; construction-cost-vs-USD-price swings can savage margins mid-build; and rural/Patagonia land carries foreign-ownership restrictions in active litigation. **Opportunistic only** — and if entered, favor urban builds (Buenos Aires, Mendoza city) over border/lake land, priced defensively against peso swings. Revisit once the golden-visa regs publish and the rural-land law settles.

Sources: NAR 2025; State Dept / INEGI / ARCR; TheLatininvestor; Global Property Guide; MexLaw / Mexperience (fideicomiso, residency); Ley 9996; Decree 524/2025; Atlantic Council / Chequeado (Argentina). All per-m² figures are estimates; see Appendix.

13 Unit Economics & Financials

Little capital per build, recycled quickly, proven on cash before debt — and a model that scales the same way in every market.

13.1 • The per-home P&L (illustrative, \$400K sale)

Line	Amount	Note
Sale price (turnkey, titled, visa-ready)	\$400,000	\$350–500K across tiers/markets
Build cost (~180 m² @ ~\$1,400/m²)	~\$250,000	Validated vs subcontractor quotes
Land (partner option, at cost)	~\$40,000	Profit-share, minimal cash outflow
Soft costs (design, permits, oversight)	~\$30,000	Architecture, permits, management
Gross profit / home	\$80K–\$150K	22–28% margin

13.2 • The 24-month Panama outline

Window	Activity	Revenue	Gross profit
Mo 1–6	Builds 1–2 in flight; no closings	\$0	(\$80K) burn
Mo 7–12	Deliveries 1–2; builds 3–6	\$800K	\$200K
Mo 13–18	Deliveries 3–8; builds 9–14	\$3.2M	\$800K
Mo 19–24	Deliveries 9–18; builds 15–24	\$7.5M	\$1.8M
Cumulative	30 homes delivered	~\$12M	~\$2.8M

CAPITAL STORY

Peak cash deployed is \$200–300K, recovered by ~month 14 — a fraction of committed founder capital. First two to three builds self-funded to prove the model; thereafter buyer deposits finance 60–80% of each build and capital recycles with positive carry. Per-build IRR on deployed capital is highly attractive. The Panama proof unlocks both construction debt and the Mexico launch.

13.3 • Acquisition economics

\$75 COST PER LEAD	\$250–500 COST PER DISCOVERY CALL	\$7,500 COST PER BUYER (PAID)	<2% CAC / REVENUE
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And tourism + referral channels drive a rising share of closings at *near-zero* CAC, pushing blended acquisition cost down as the business scales — the inverse of a paid-only competitor.

I4 Execution & Expansion Roadmap

Prove Panama, then carry the proof into the region. Two timelines: the Panama 24-month build, and the multi-country sequence.

I4.1 • Panama — 24 months

Phase	Headline moves	KPI exit
Mo 1–3 • Foundation	Entity + broker + attorneys + escrow; 6 land options; 2 models + configurator live; 4 SEO pillars; QIV page; \$5K/mo paid test; first self-funded build	60 leads, 8 calls, 2 visits, 1 LOI
Mo 4–6 • Validation	5 models live; \$15K/mo + first IL sponsorship; host training; first Discovery Weekends; first home delivered	200 leads/mo, 6 visits, 2 contracts/mo
Mo 7–12 • Scale	\$30K/mo; conference sponsorship; first Sora Sunday; LOC; 6–8 builds	400 leads/mo, 4 contracts/mo
Mo 13–18 • Authority	#1 for "build a house in Panama"; custom configurator; annual gathering; 15–20 builds	500 leads/mo, 4–6 contracts/mo
Mo 19–24 • Compounding	Referrals = 30%+ of closings; concierge revenue; Mexico market study	6 contracts/mo, \$1.5M run-rate GP

I4.2 • The multi-country sequence

Window	Panama	Mexico	Costa Rica
Year 1	Build the proof (first deliveries, testimonials)	—	—
Year 2	Scale to 30 homes; brand authority	Market study + first land partners (San Miguel / Mérida inland entry)	—
Year 3	Self-funding; concierge revenue	First builds + configurator localized; fideicomiso concierge	Market study; co-broke partners

THE CRITICAL PATH — WHAT MUST NOT SLIP (PANAMA)

Mo 1 — entity + broker + attorneys. Mo 2 — 6 land options. Mo 3 — configurator live with 2 models. Mo 6 — first home delivered + first Discovery Weekends. Mo 12 — LOC drawn or proven unnecessary. Everything else flexes 30 days.

15 Risks & Mitigations

The honest list, now spanning four countries. Each is real; each has a designed hedge.

Risk	Mitigation
Visa-deadline moves — Panama QIV (Oct '26) and CR investor sunset (Jul '26) are decree/legislation-based and have shifted before.	Confirm with counsel before external use; the model stands on the build economics, not the visa — the visa is a hook, not the foundation.
Title / ownership exposure — Panama ROP (Bocas >85%), Mexico fideicomiso reform pending, CR maritime concessions.	Titled-only standard everywhere; clean-title guarantee as a product; localized ownership concierge per market.
Construction delay / overrun — the anecdote that kills retiree deals.	Fixed-price subcontracts before sale; validated BOMs; milestone escrow; penalty clauses both ways; self-funded first builds debug the process.
Multi-market execution risk — spreading too thin before Panama is proven.	Strict sequencing: no Mexico builds until Panama delivers 30 homes and is cash-flow positive; localized partners, not remote management.
Currency / macro — peso (MX/AR), colón (CR); Fitch junk (PA).	Panama is dollarized (the beachhead's edge); price builds in USD; Argentina stays on watch precisely for this reason.
Thin market data — no national MLS in any market; prices are asking, not closed.	Commission one local broker + attorney per market for closed comps before scaling spend; the Sora Build Index becomes proprietary data.
Brand-boundary pollution — bolting sales onto the travel brand.	Hard separation rules; host incentives tied to NPS; travel data never used for unsolicited outbound.

I6 Status & The Ask

The strategy is done and the digital spine is largely built. The business is gated on a small set of unblocks — most of them decisions, not dollars.

I6.1 • What's already built

- The full strategic research corpus (market, keywords, paid, personas, tourism funnel, community, ranking strategy, channel & broker databases, the demand-generation operating system) — now extended with this multi-country research.
- Live lead funnels — QIV countdown, build-cost guide, Discovery Weekend — with shared capture, analytics and UTM attribution.
- The Lead Machine and Land Bank dashboards; SEO foundation; legal pages; centralized configuration.

I6.2 • What's needed (the gates)

Gate	Items
0 • The spine (≈15 min of decisions)	Real WhatsApp + lead-capture endpoint wired in; register the domain; analytics IDs; the lead→close pipeline tracker.
Legal / entity	Sora Real Estate Panama S.A. (Promotora) + holding; managing broker + ACOBIR; closing & immigration attorneys; bank + escrow.
Inventory	6 land option agreements; titled-only verification.
Product	2 hero models finalized + plans; validated BOMs (3 tiers); fixed-price subcontracts.
Proof	First self-funded build broken ground and documented.

THE ASK

Self-fund the first two to three Panama builds from founder capital — peak deployment \$200–300K, recovered by ~month 14 — to prove unit economics before any debt. Commit the four foundation decisions in the next 60–90 days to capture the Oct 2026 visa-deadline wave. Panama's proof is what funds and de-risks the move into Mexico — the larger prize.

THREE SIGNALS WE'RE WINNING, BY MONTH 24

1 · A foreign buyer in Sarasota, Toronto, or London has heard "Sora" before "Casa Solution" or "Panama Equity." 2 · A Sora homeowner has introduced 3+ friends, unprompted. 3 · Sora is cash-flow positive without further capital — and the Mexico study is underway. If those are true, the next five years are execution speed, not strategy.

Sources & Method

Every load-bearing figure, attributed. Compiled June 18, 2026 from current public sources. Figures are official (government, IMF/World Bank, NAR, large-platform) or estimate (broker/agency/modeled), flagged in text.

VISAS, MACRO & OWNERSHIP (ALL FOUR COUNTRIES)

Panama QIV / FNV / Pensionado: Global Citizen Solutions; Kraemer & Kraemer; IMI Daily; Decree 722/2020 & reported 193/2024 · Mexico fideicomiso & residency: MexLaw; Mexperience; INEGI UMA 2026; Constitution Art. 27 · Costa Rica: Ley 9996 (investor \$150K, Jul 14 2026 sunset); Decree 37112; Ley 6043 (maritime zone) · Argentina: Decree 524/2025 (golden visa); cepo lift Apr 2025 + \$20B IMF; Ley 26.737 (rural land) · Macro: IMF/World Bank; S&P/Moody's/Fitch; PwC; Dentons.

MARKETS, PRICES & BUILD COSTS

Panama: Global Property Guide; Casa Solution; Metro Realty; Properstar; AirROI; PanaCrypto; livinginpanama · Mexico: TheLatinvestor; CB La Costa; Airtbtics/AirROI; BRNL Architecture; Zisla · Costa Rica: Global Property Guide; Osa Tropical Properties; ArchitectEngineer.cr · Argentina: Global Property Guide; IDECBA; Zonaprop · Build-side competitors: company sites; panama-properties; Prestige; retireinpanamatours (Caldera).

U.S. BUYER, DEMAND & CHANNELS

Relocation intent: Harris Poll 2025; Gallup 2025; WSJ/Daily Beast 2026; moveBuddha · Pools: SSA Annual Statistical Supplement 2024 (Table 5.J); AARP; MBO Partners 2025; GummySearch (subreddit sizes) · Geographies: Census & IRS migration FY24; United Van Lines 48th; SmartAsset · Affinity: Parrot Analytics/HGTV (House Hunters); Coldwell Banker Global Luxury 2023 · Ad/funnel benchmarks: WordStream 2026 & FB 2025; Unbounce; First Page Sage; Landingi; NAR 2025; MIT/HBR (lead response) · Channels: International Living; Live and Invest Overseas; Panama Relocation Tours; RETA; Nomad Capitalist; Similarweb; acobir.com.

METHOD & CONFIDENCE

High confidence: visa thresholds & the three load-bearing dates; Panama USD peg; territorial tax; GDP & ratings; ownership law (Art. 17/27/Ley 6043); NAR foreign-buyer data; ad-platform benchmarks; tourism arrivals; SSA-abroad count. **Treat as indicative:** all micro-market price/m² (broker asking values, no national MLS in any market); expat-population counts; market-size and foreign-share narrative figures; self-reported channel reach; subreddit sizes (third-party trackers). **Before external circulation:** (1) confirm the Panama QIV, Costa Rica sunset, and Argentina golden-visa status with local counsel; (2) commission one local broker + attorney per target market for closed comps; (3) refresh live channel metrics. Synthesizes Sora's internal research files 00–13 with fresh June-2026 web research across four countries.